ASSETS · TRADING

Reading charts

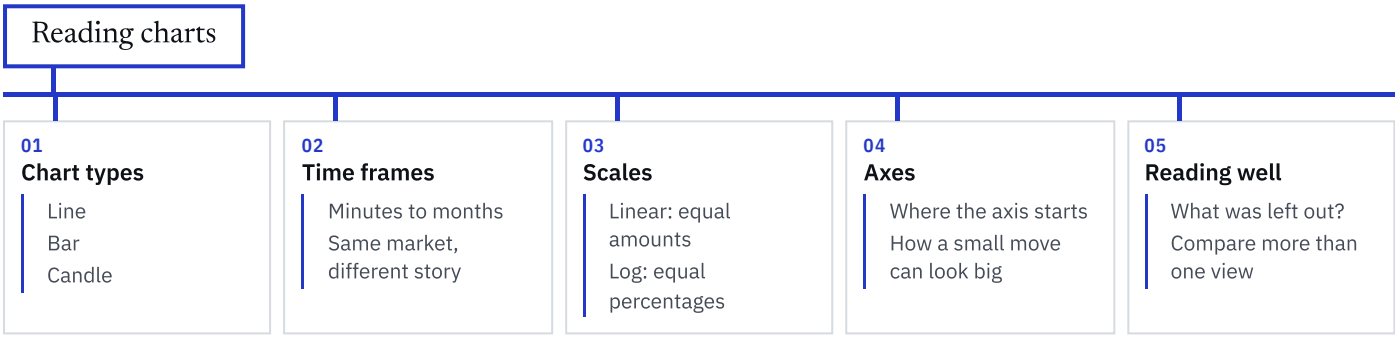
Lines, time frames and scales, and what each one hides.

PLANNED

What you will learn

A chart is a drawing of prices over time, and every drawing makes choices. A line chart shows closes and hides what happened in between. A one-minute view and a one-week view tell different stories about the same market. On a linear scale a steady percentage rise looks like it is speeding up; a log scale shows equal percentage moves as equal steps. And an axis that does not start at zero can make a small move look large. This piece teaches you to ask what a chart leaves out before you trust it. Education only, never advice.

Map of the piece



Sources

1 **Graphical Perception: Theory, Experimentation, and Application to the Development of Graphical Methods**
William S. Cleveland and Robert McGill, Journal of the American Statistical Association, 1984
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2 **Truncating the Y-Axis: Threat or Menace?**
Michael Correll, Enrico Bertini and Steven Franconeri, CHI 2020, 2020
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3 **Pine Script v6 User Manual: Timeframes**
TradingView, 2026
tradingview.com

Each source was opened and checked on 14 October 2026. The finished piece may add more.